2ND EDITION · NOV 2026

The AI Character Playbook

How Uncle Toussaint went from 8 followers to millions of views, and the exact system to build your own.

1.7M
views on TikTok



1.3M
views on Instagram

By the creator of
@uncletoussaint

INSPECTED ✓

START HERE

Hi! Welcome to the playbook.



UNCLE TOUSSAINT SAYS

Welcome. Please remain seated. Inspection begins now.

This is the full system behind Uncle Toussaint: how he was designed, kept looking like *himself*, turned into videos, posted, tracked and monetized. Every number inside is a real number from the real account, with its date. Work through it in order the first time.

Part 1 · Build

Chapters 1–4
The proof, the design, the identity lock and the reference pack.

Part 2 · Make

Chapters 5–8
Prompts, formats, production and captions.

Part 3 · Grow

Chapters 9–12
Posting, reading your data, earning, and selling your own playbook.

Part 4 · Go!

Chapters 13–15
A 14-day plan, copy-ready templates, and honest limits.

THE ONE RULE BEHIND EVERYTHING

Consistency beats novelty.

The same face, the same outfit, the same tone, in a new situation every day. People don't fall in love with your best video. They fall in love with recognizing your character in the first half-second of the next one.

Everything here is a method and a record of what worked once, in full view. Nothing promises you views, followers or income.

YOUR TOOLKIT

Start free. Spend only when it works.

You don't need a studio or a budget to create the character. Three tools do the whole job.

FREE TO START

Gemini

Generate your character and build the reference sheet: the angles and close-ups that keep the face the same.

FREE TO START

ChatGPT

Develop the concept, write and refine your identity lock, and draft prompts and captions in your character's voice.

VIDEO

Higgsfield

Turns your character sheet into short video beats you stitch together and post. Pay for credits only once the character works.

The whole workflow on one line

1 Design — ChatGPT → 2 Lock it — text → 3 Sheet — Gemini → 4 Video — Higgsfield → 5 Post — every app

What it costs (real figures from this account)

Step	Cost
Designing the character and the reference sheet	$0 with free Gemini and ChatGPT
One 16-second swap-style video	32 credits, about **$1.69** on the $211 credit pack
Stitching beats into a finished post	A free editor such as CapCut
Reading your results	$0, built into Instagram and TikTok

Prices and credit packs change. The habit that matters: know your cost per finished video before you scale posting. Plans and limits of the free tools can change too, so check each one before you start.

1 THE CASE STUDY

Strangers shared it. That's the whole game.

Uncle Toussaint launched on **26 October 2026** with 8 followers. The engine was one post: the masquerade reel. By 8 November the numbers below were real, with the Instagram figures pulled from Instagram's own insights.

1.3M
views on the masquerade reel (Instagram)

16.1K
shares of that one reel

2.48M
Instagram views in 30 days

98%
of those views came from non-followers

5,343
Instagram followers (from 8)

1.7M
views on the "physics" reel (TikTok)

Read those numbers the right way

Likes did not build this account. Shares did. A share is a viewer doing your distribution for you, putting your character in front of people who have never heard of you. Only 43,427 of the 2,479,007 Instagram views came from followers, about 1.8%. Everyone else was a stranger.

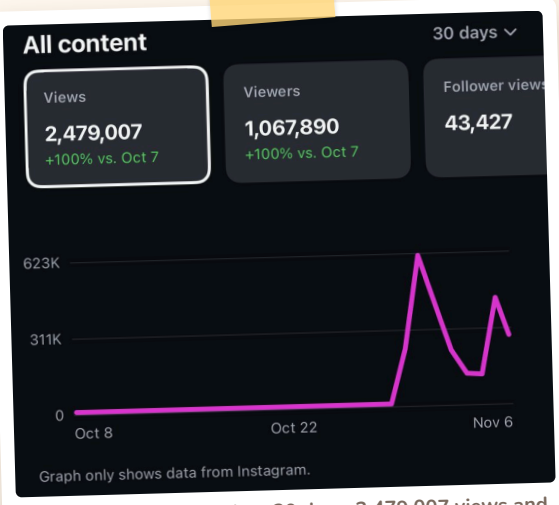
So the whole method points at one target: **make a character so recognizable, in a format so familiar, that a stranger shares it in the first three seconds.** Everything after this chapter is how.

First look vs. latest look

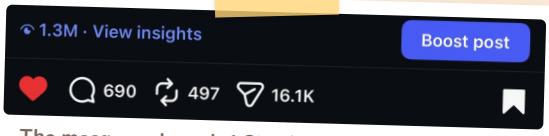
	First edition (day 12)	Latest (8 Nov)
Masquerade reel views	506,177	1.3M
Shares of that reel	3,382	16.1K
Instagram followers	5,323	5,343

The reel kept travelling after the first edition was written. Numbers move: always date yours.

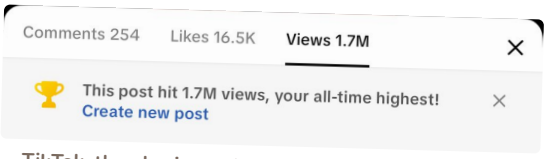
Don't take my word. Here are the screenshots.



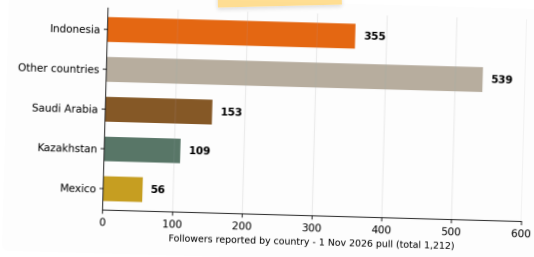
Instagram dashboard, last 30 days: 2,479,007 views and 1,067,890 viewers.



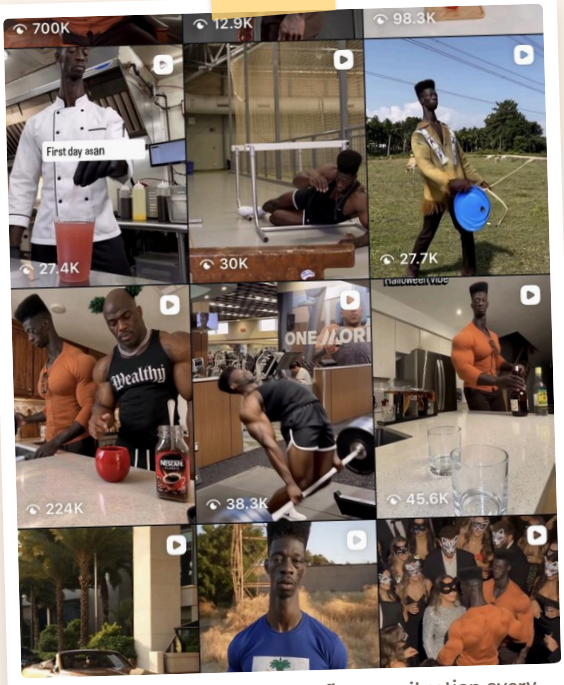
The masquerade reel: 1.3M views, 690 comments, 497 reposts, 16.1K shares.



TikTok: the physics reel at 1.7M views, flagged as the account's all-time highest.



Where the early followers were (1 Nov pull, 1,212 followers reported by country). Follower data is a partial map: chapter 10 shows you how to read viewer data instead.



The grid: same face, same outfit, new situation every time. Views range from 12.9K to 1.3M.

2 DESIGN

One or two odd features beat a realistic face every time.

A realistic, handsome, generic AI person is invisible: the feed is full of them. A character people stop for has a **silhouette a viewer can name from a thumbnail, in half a second, with no caption.**

The Toussaint formula

- **One exaggerated feature:** a comically long, slender neck.
- **One rigid feature:** a tall flat-top fade that never changes shape.
- **One costume anchor:** a massive bodybuilder physique in a tight orange 1970s knit cardigan, thick glasses on a chain.
- **One expression:** a deadpan, unblinking stare. He never smiles at the joke.
- **One job:** a street-level inspector of posture, form and structural integrity. Most things fail.



The side profile proves the exaggerated feature. If the silhouette doesn't read instantly, the design isn't done.

Design your own the same way

1. Pick **one physical exaggeration** a child could draw: a neck, a chin, ears, hair, height, posture.
2. Pick **one outfit** worn almost every time. One colour a viewer can spot in a grid.
3. Pick **one expression** and hold it. The comedy is the gap between the character's seriousness and the situation.
4. Give the character **one repeatable job or obsession.** A job generates infinite episodes; a look alone runs out in a week.
5. Write it all in **one paragraph.** That paragraph becomes your identity lock.

The one-second test: show someone a still for one second, then hide it. If they can't describe the character back to you, the design is not finished.

3 THE IDENTITY LOCK

Write the lock once. Paste it into every prompt.

AI video tools **drift**: faces soften, hair shrinks, and your character's key feature quietly disappears by the third generation. The fix is boring and it works: a fixed block of text, the **identity lock**, pasted into every prompt, word for word.

Toussaint's real lock

COPY ME

```
Uncle Toussaint, 49, dignified old-school Haitian uncle: comically long slender neck, massive bodybuilder physique straining inside a tight orange 1970s knit cardigan, tall rigid flat-top fade haircut, thick glasses on a chain, dark weathered skin with visible pores, deadpan unblinking stare. His hands are empty. He takes himself 100% seriously.
```

What makes a lock work

1 · Name the odd features explicitly.
"His very long neck" and "his tall rigid flat-top fade". The tool protects what you name.

2 · Include behaviour, not just looks.
"He takes himself 100% seriously" is an acting direction, and it is the joke.

3 · Include one restriction.
Toussaint's is "hands empty": no props unless the bit itself is the prop.

4 · Freeze it.
Improve the wording? Change it everywhere at once and note the date. Two locks means two characters.

Build your own: the template

TEMPLATE

```
[Name], [age], [one-line persona]: [exaggerated feature], [second rigid feature], [signature outfit], [hair / head feature], [skin / surface detail], [default expression]. [One restriction, e.g. hands empty.] [One behaviour line: how seriously they take themselves.]
```



WHEN THE FACE DRIFTS
Add more reference angles and shorten the source clip. Drift compounds.

4 THE REFERENCE PACK

Five angles at one scale hold a face better than fifty random stills.



Toussaint's real character sheet: five full-body views above three chest-up close-ups.

Text alone will not hold a character. Video tools that accept reference images hold the face when the references **agree with each other.** Build the pack once, before your first real video.

Build yours in this order

1. **The sheet first:** five full-body views, same scale, same outfit, same light.
2. **Three close-ups:** front, three-quarter and side profile, chest-up, in the default expression.
3. **Two backup singles:** a front chest-up and a pure side profile. The profile is what proves the exaggerated feature.
4. **One alternate outfit only** if the character truly needs it, kept in a separate folder so it never leaks into the default look.

Do it free with Gemini and ChatGPT

STEP A · ChatGPT

Turn your idea into a lock.

Tell it your one exaggeration, outfit, expression and job, and ask it to write a single tight paragraph with a behaviour line and one restriction. Save the result as your lock.

STEP B · Gemini

Turn the lock into the sheet.

Paste the lock and ask for a character sheet: five full-body angles at one scale, plain grey background, same light, then close-ups. Regenerate until the odd feature is identical in every view.

SAMPLE PROMPT

```
Character reference sheet. [PASTE YOUR IDENTITY LOCK]. Five full-body views at the same scale (front, three-quarter front, side, three-quarter back, back). Plain light-grey studio background, soft even light, same outfit in every view. Below: three chest-up close-ups (front, three-quarter, side profile).
```

When a video tool lets you add more references, add **angles**, not new outfits.

5 PROMPTS

Camera, Tone, Lighting, Texture. In that order, every time.

A prompt written as a pile of adjectives gives you a pile of results. The structure that repeats is **four parts**, one or two sentences each, always in the same order, with the identity lock inside the Tone part.

Part	What it decides
1 · Camera	Lens and framing: "35mm lens, slightly low side view, full-body framing, slight motion blur." This is what makes it feel *shot*, not rendered.
2 · Tone	Mood first, then who is in it, doing what, where. **The identity lock lives here.**
3 · Lighting	Direction and quality: "Harsh midday sun, hard shadows on the pavement." One light source, named.
4 · Texture	Materials and surface detail: knit, skin pores, cracked concrete, film grain. Texture is where realism actually comes from.

A complete, real example: the sidewalk inspection

REAL PROMPT

```
Camera: Candid 35mm film photograph, slightly low side view, full-body framing,
crooked composition, slight motion blur.
Tone: Deadpan, serious and absurd, like a formal inspection caught by a passerby.
[IDENTITY LOCK] He stands rigidly inspecting a cracked sidewalk, deadpan and
unblinking, hands empty.
Lighting: Harsh midday sun, hard shadows on the pavement, bright foreground and
darker street behind.
Texture: Tight knit cardigan texture, dark weathered skin with visible pores, rough
cracked concrete, dust and film grain.
```

For video

Keep the same four parts and add **one action** with a clear start and end. One beat per clip (chapter 7).

Pro tip

Ask ChatGPT to fill the four parts for a new situation, then **paste your lock in yourself** so it never gets reworded.

6 FORMATS

Steal the format, not the video.

New accounts don't have time to invent formats and test them. The platforms already tell you what's working: it's the video with two million views in your niche *this week*. Take that format (the structure, the timing, the beat) and put **your character** in it.

The rules

- **Remake the structure, never repost the video.** Their clip is research, not content.
- **One clear person, clean light, similar build** in the source clip makes the cleanest swap.
- **Your character must change the joke.** If the video would work identically with anyone in it, your character is decoration, not the star.
- **Keep a shortlist.** Save candidate formats as you scroll, review them weekly, and shoot the top two or three, not all of them.

Formats that fit an inspector character

🎯 **The deadpan test that fails**
Archery at a disc, a hurdle, a deadlift: attempt, fail, verdict.

🤫 **The silent professional**
He does an ordinary job (chef, barista) without a word, then walks off.

👯 **The twin test**
He inspects an identical copy of himself, and fails him.

🏗️ **The public inspection**
A mundane place or object, graded like a building site.

⏱️ **Spacing rule:** do not run the same beat twice in a row. Two fall endings back to back turn a surprise into a routine. Alternate: a fall, then a silent one, then an inspection.



FORMAT INSPECTED
Source video: researched. Copying: not allowed. Character: starring.

7 PRODUCTION

Short beats, stitched, at a cost you know before you start.

AI video is sold in seconds, so produce in seconds. Plan each generation as **one beat of about 8 to 16 seconds** with a clear start and end, then stitch beats together in an editor such as CapCut. A 30-second video is three good beats, not one long drifting generation.

The workflow

1. **Hook in the first second.** Open on the verdict moment (the crack, the lean, the fail), not on a walk-in.
2. **Generate the beat in Higgsfield** with your character sheet as the reference and your identity lock in the prompt.
3. **Check the lock before anything else:** face, key feature, outfit, expression. Drifted? Regenerate that beat only.
4. **Keep audio ambient** in the generation (street noise, room tone). Add the trending sound later, on the platform, so it stays current.
5. **Stitch, caption, post.** The caption is written *before* you generate, not after (chapter 8).

What a video actually cost in this case study

Item	Real figure from the account
Swap-style generation	32 credits for a 16-second video
Cost per video on the $211 credit pack	About $1.69 per video
Text-to-video beats	About 8 seconds per beat, stitched for longer pieces

Beat checklist

- [ ] Starts on the verdict moment
- [ ] One action, clear start and end
- [ ] Same face, neck and flat-top
- [ ] Hands empty (unless the prop is the bit)

Know your number

Prices change. Know your cost per finished video before you scale posting, and price any client work from that number, not from a guess.

8 CAPTIONS

A caption is a verdict: under 15 words, zero hashtags.

The video is the evidence. The caption is the ruling. Toussaint's captions follow a formal-report formula: **what was inspected, what failed, what it means**. Short sentences, completely deadpan, never winking at the joke.

Real captions from the account

Archery test
Target inspected. Aim: failed. Disc: survived.

Hurdle
Hurdle inspected. Clearance: failed. Landing: worse.

Food-truck chef
Drink inspected. Ingredients: unknown. Verdict: served anyway.

Physics bulb test (1.7M views on TikTok)
Bulb tested. Lamp: lit. Verdict: unclear.

Fancy cafe
First time here. Posture: perfect. Etiquette: failed.

Twin inspection
I inspected myself. I failed.

The formula, for any character

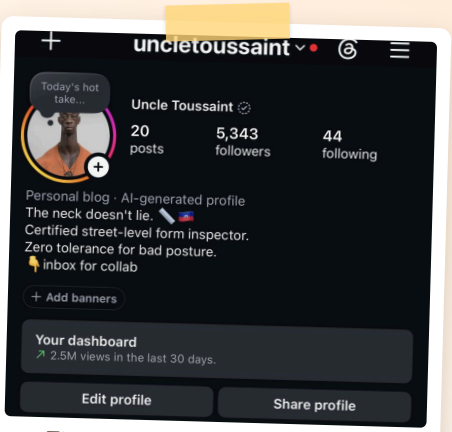
- One short verdict, **under 15 words**.
- **Zero hashtags.** The character is the discovery mechanism, not the tags.
- Emojis almost never. For Toussaint, only the flag or the ruler, occasionally.
- **Never explain in the caption that the character is AI.** Labelling AI content is a platform setting (next chapter), not copy.
- Write the caption in the **character's voice**, not yours. If the character wouldn't say it in a formal report, rewrite it.

9 POSTING

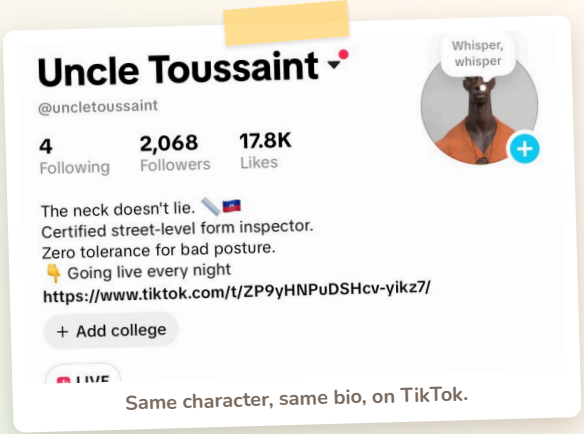
Every platform, same character, labelled as AI.

A character compounds when the same person appears everywhere a viewer might land. Post the same video to **Instagram, TikTok and YouTube Shorts** and let each platform find its own audience for it.

- **Post everywhere, at the same time.** Don't hold a platform back to "test". The test *is* the posting.
- **Turn on the AI label** on every post, in the platform's own setting. It protects the account and it's increasingly the honest norm. The joke survives it, because the character never pretended to be a documentary.
- **Link in bio from day one.** Even before you have a product, it's where future money lands: a tip jar, a storefront, or a sales page.
- **Consistency over perfection.** A good-enough video today beats a perfect one next week. The lock makes "good enough" still look like the same person.
- **Collaborations count double.** Post collabs as a true platform collaboration (both profiles), not a tag in the caption.



The real profile: bio in character, AI-generated label on, 5,343 followers.



Same character, same bio, on TikTok.

The silhouette test

If the side profile doesn't read instantly in the thumbnail, the post isn't ready. Check it before you publish.

10 YOUR DATA

Viewers are not followers, and their map lives in the reel, not the profile.

The most common data mistake with a viral AI character: opening follower demographics and calling it your audience. When about 98% of views come from people who don't follow you, follower data describes almost nobody who watched. **Viewer data is per-video.**

Check your viewers yourself (Instagram)

1. Open the reel and tap **View insights** under the video.
2. Read **accounts reached / views, watch time, shares, and follows from this reel.** Shares and follows-per-view are the numbers that predict the next hit.
3. For **where viewers are**, use the audience section of that reel's insights where your account and region offer it, and the Professional Dashboard's audience view for the account overall. Treat follower geography only as a partial map, clearly labelled as followers, not viewers.
4. In the app, **Settings and activity → Insights** gives account-level reach and the content that drove it over the last 30 to 90 days. (TikTok has the same idea: open a video and tap **More insights**.)

What to record weekly

Number	Why it matters
Shares per post	Distribution you didn't pay for. The masquerade reel's 16.1K shares built the account.
Follows per post	Tells you which format converts strangers into followers.
% non-follower viewers	High means the format travels. Low means you're only feeding existing fans.
Viewer geography (per reel)	Tells you what language, references and posting times the next video should use.

Honest limit: some viewer breakdowns only exist inside the app, per reel, and third-party tools can't pull them for you. Anyone selling you a complete viewer map from outside the app is guessing. Check it in the app, screenshot it, and file it with the post.

11 MONETIZATION

Earn in the order it unlocks. Don't wait for the platform to pay you.

At a few thousand followers, Instagram is **proof, not a payer**. The money that's actually available early comes from people and brands paying for what the character can do. Here is the ladder, in the order it realistically opens.

NOW	**Personalized verdicts.** Fans pay for the character to inspect their photo, product, gym form or party, delivered as a short video or image verdict.
NOW	**Product-inspection UGC.** A brand pays the character to "inspect" its product on camera. The deadpan format *is* the ad.
NOW	**Collaborations.** Joint posts with other creators trade audiences. Paid collabs follow once your reach is proven.
NOW	**Affiliate links.** Link the tools you actually use to make the character, in the bio.
NOW	**Your own playbook or course.** Your documented process, sold as a PDF (chapter 12). This document is the example.
~1,000	**Creator Marketplace.** Meta's brand-deal marketplace, once the account qualifies.
LATER	**Merch.** Works once a catchphrase or image is famous enough that strangers want it on a shirt. Best as a limited drop.
10,000	**Subscriptions and Live Badges.** Platform fan payments. Real money, but a later rung. Don't plan around it early.
INVITE	**Bonuses.** Platform bonus programs can't be applied for on demand. Treat any invite as a windfall, not a plan.

Thresholds are the platform rules as known when this edition was written and can change. Check the current rules in the app before planning around any single one.

12 SELL THE SYSTEM

Your process is a product, and the market has already priced it.

Once your character works, the method itself becomes sellable, because thousands of people want the result you already have. This isn't theory: it's what creators in this exact niche are doing. When this playbook was researched, comparable AI-character playbooks and courses were selling at roughly **$14.99, $19.99 and $29.90 to $69.90**, usually as a PDF plus extras.

How to package yours

1. **Lead with your case study.** Your dated, real numbers are the sales page. Screenshots beat adjectives.
2. **Price inside the proven band.** Around $19.99 to $29 for a PDF playbook; move higher only if you add a video walkthrough or a tool. A short launch price (this playbook launched at $9 for two weeks, then $29) gives early buyers a reason to act.
3. **Sell where creators already buy:** a store link in your bio and on your showcase site.
4. **Give the templates away inside the product,** not on the sales page: the lock, the prompt structure, the caption bank, the checklists.
5. **Promise the method, never the outcome.** Say what the system is and what it did on your account, with dates. That keeps you honest and out of refund trouble: results depend on the buyer's character and execution.

🔁 The loop

The character promotes the playbook, the playbook teaches new characters, and every buyer's result becomes social proof for both. **Your account is the ad. This PDF is the product.**

Example: how this playbook was priced

$9	$29	$$
launch price for the first two weeks	regular price for the PDF playbook	higher only if you add a video walkthrough or tool

13 LAUNCH PLAN

Your first 14 days, day by day.

DAY 1 Design
One odd feature, one outfit, one expression, one job. Write the one-paragraph description.

DAY 2 Lock it
Write the identity lock from that paragraph. Freeze it.

DAY 3 Character sheet
Five full-body angles at one scale (Gemini).

DAY 4 Close-ups
Three close-ups and two backup singles. Save the pack in one folder.

DAY 5 Shortlist
Scroll your niche for one hour. Save ten proven formats.

DAY 6 Captions first
Write three captions, then three prompts (four parts, lock inside).

DAY 7 Video one
Generate it in Higgsfield. Lock-check frame by frame. Regenerate drifted beats only.

DAY 8 Accounts
Bio in character, profile still from the sheet, link in bio, AI label understood.

DAY 9 Post video one
Everywhere, same day. Note the time.

DAY 10 Post video two
A different beat from video one (no repeated gimmick back to back).

DAY 11 Read insights
Shares, follows, % non-followers on both posts. Write them down.

DAY 12 Post video three
Use whichever of the first two formats travelled further.

DAY 13 Money basics
A tip or verdict offer in the bio link, one affiliate link for your main tool.

DAY 14 Review
Compare the week against chapter 10's table. Pick next week's three formats from data, not taste.

Fourteen days won't make you viral. It gives you **a locked character, three posted videos, real data and a money link live**, which is more than most accounts ever build, and everything the Toussaint account had underneath its first run.

14 COPY-READY

Templates and checklists: copy these exactly.

Identity lock template

COPY ME

```
[Name], [age], [one-line persona]: [exaggerated feature], [second rigid feature], [signature outfit], [hair / head feature], [skin / surface detail], [default expression]. [One restriction, e.g. hands empty.] [One behaviour line: how seriously they take themselves.]
```

Four-part prompt template

COPY ME

```
Camera: [lens, framing, angle, motion].
Tone: [mood]. [IDENTITY LOCK] [one action with a clear start and end, where].
Lighting: [one named light source and direction].
Texture: [materials, skin, surfaces, grain].
```

Caption bank

Inspector voice. Adapt the nouns.

- [Thing] inspected. [Skill]: failed. [Thing]: survived.
- First time here. Posture: perfect. Etiquette: failed.
- [Thing] inspected. Ingredients: unknown. Verdict: served anyway.
- I inspected myself. I failed.
- Physics inspected. [Thing]: tested. Science: pending.
- [Thing] tested. [Thing]: lit. Verdict: unclear.

Pre-post checklist

- [ ] Face matches the character sheet
- [ ] Key feature at full size: not shrunk, not softened
- [ ] Default outfit, or the outfit the bit requires
- [ ] Hands empty, unless the prop is the bit
- [ ] Last seconds scrubbed for glitched gestures
- [ ] Caption under 15 words, zero hashtags
- [ ] AI label turned on
- [ ] Posted to every platform, link in bio working

15 HONEST LIMITS

What breaks a character, and what nobody can promise you.

Lock breaks to catch before you post

👕 **Costume drift**

A random outfit (a fringed jacket instead of the cardigan) makes the character a stranger for one post. Role uniforms, like a chef coat for a kitchen bit, are the exception because the job explains them.

🌀 **AI morphs**

A body or face that changes mid-clip pulls every eye to the glitch. If it wasn't intentional, regenerate: viewers will comment on the morph, not the joke.

🖐 **Ambiguous gestures**

A glitched hand can read as a rude gesture to camera. Scrub the last seconds of every clip before posting.

🎭 **Tone breaks**

A bit that makes the character creepy instead of strict (peeking instead of inspecting) damages the persona the account is built on. Hold those clips.

🏷 **Branding accidents.** A visible product logo in a gag reads as an unpaid ad, and a powder-on-the-nose joke reads as a drug gag. Decide both deliberately, never by accident.

The honest limits of this playbook

One account, one viral post, under two weeks. That is a real result and a small sample. The method raises your odds (a recognizable character, proven formats, consistent posting, honest data) but **no playbook can promise a viral post, a follower count or an income,** and you shouldn't buy or sell one that does.

What this system *does* give you is **cheaper learning**: every video costs about the price of a coffee, every mistake is visible in the lock-check, and every result is in your own insights within a day.



INSPECTION COMPLETE

Character: buildable.
System: repeatable.
Results: yours to earn.

Uncle Toussaint lives at **@uncletoussaint** on Instagram and TikTok. The playbook's home is **toussaint.getaurorastudios.com**.

Uncle Toussaint is a fictional, AI-generated character. All figures are real numbers from the account with dates as given; they are a record of one account, not a promise of your results. © 2026 The AI Character Playbook, 2nd edition.